

## Plain Language Statement

Melbourne School of Psychological Sciences



***Project: Bilingual Perspectives on Crosslingual Semantic Variation.***

### **Responsible Researcher:**

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## **Introduction**

Thank you for your interest in participating in this experiment. Please read this Plain Language Statement carefully to decide whether you would like to participate in this study. If you have any questions, please contact the responsible researcher.

### **What is this research about?**

This study investigates what the commonalities and difference in meaning are for words in different languages. This project is funded through a Google Asia-Pacific but will not in any way impact the research design, execution or dissemination nor will it directly benefit from any results.

### **What will I be asked to do?**

You will first be asked to complete demographic questions including information about your language background and vocabulary. You will be asked to judge how well the meaning between word pairs correspond in the form of a rating or relatedness judgements and/or determine what aspects of a word's meaning is shared across languages or unique. The time to complete this study is estimated to be 30 minutes.

### **What are the possible benefits?**

Using your data, we can create a set of norms that give us information about what aspects of meaning are shared across languages and what aspects are language unique. This will allow us to refine existing psychological models by accounting for the diversity of mental representations for common words in different languages. Participants who finish the task will receive 20 AUD/hour.

### **What are the possible risks?**

There are minimal risks involved in this study. The words presented will all be common and non-sensitive words. You will participate anonymously and no identifying information will be collected. Participation is voluntary and you can withdraw at any point with no consequence.

### **Do I have to take part?**

No, participation is entirely voluntary. You will not be penalised if you wish to withdraw at any point in the experiment. The data for incomplete studies will not be stored and, therefore, will not be used for analysis. However, please note that you must finish the task to receive payment

### **Will I hear about the results of this project?**

The results of this research may be published in conference presentations and research papers which will be made available through the research's group webpage (<https://psychologicalsciences.unimelb.edu.au/chdh>). Following completion, you will be provided with a debriefing form summarising the aims of the project.

### **What will happen to information about me?**

We will protect your confidentiality as best we can, subject to limits of the law. Data from this study will be stored in a password-protected system (OneDrive) owned by the research team and made available only to the researchers listed at the top of the Plain Language Statement. The data will also later be made available online for research and community use. As a result, consenting to this study entails also consenting to collected information being shared forever and potentially used in further, unrelated research. No identifying information will be required to participate in the study, and your data will be pseudonymised as part of a very large dataset. As such, we aim to protect your privacy and confidentiality to the best of our ability.

### **Where can I get further information?**

If you would like more information about the project, please contact the researchers: Dr Simon De Deyne ([simon.dedeyne@unimelb.edu.au](mailto:simon.dedeyne@unimelb.edu.au)).

### **Who can I contact if I have any concerns about the project?**

This project has human research ethics approval from The University of Melbourne (Project ID: 34544). If you have any concerns or complaints about the conduct of this research project, which you do not wish to discuss with the research team, you should contact the Research Integrity Administrator, Office of Research Ethics and Integrity, University of Melbourne, VIC 3010. Tel: +61 3 8344 1376 or Email: [research-integrity@unimelb.edu.au](mailto:research-integrity@unimelb.edu.au). All complaints will be treated confidentially. In any correspondence, please provide the name of the research team and/or the name or ethics ID number of the research project.